spirit of cooperation between China and India. The friendly air of Bandung contributed further to the approach of mutual friendship and trust towards China that India had pursued since the early 1950s. China's annexation of Tibet in 1951 was met with reticence in India, which tacitly recognised the move as legitimate in a 1954 agreement with Beijing that promoted exchanges with the "Tibet region of China." In the same agreement, China and India agreed to five principles of peaceful coexistence, or *panchsheel*, which included mutual respect for territorial integrity, non-aggression, and non-interference in internal affairs. Nehru also pushed for China's international recognition and tended to downplay the significance of Chinese border movements, despite China's rejection of the 1914 McMahon Line as the legitimate India–China frontier in the latter part of the decade.

But the shock of the 1962 Sino–Indian war in which India was decimated affected India deeply and called into question the very principle of non-alignment. One of the clearest challenges was Nehru's appeal to the United States during the conflict. At his behest, Washington provided India with arms and ammunition, and the State Department considered imposing an embargo on China if hostilities did not cease.[13] US support to India extended beyond the immediate conflict, moreover, with pledges of some $310 million in grants and loans from 1962 to 1965 and another $500 million in 1964 that was to be spread over a five-year period in support of India's defence.[14] Though the United States stopped short of providing modern combat weapons and failed to follow through on its 1964 pledge, American support during the conflict, subsequent economic and food aid, and pledges of continuing assistance undermined Nehru's policy by demonstrating overt dependence on the United States.